FRONTLINES

Command the war that decides the world

By Jack Lean

Playtest Requirements 4
Need 5
Want 5
Undecided 5
1.0 Introduction 6
1.1 Background 6
1.1.2 Alterra 6
1.2 Playable Alliances 6
1.2.1 Southern Stability and Trade Organisation (SSTO) 6
Alliance Overview 7
SSTO Alliance Members 7
1.2.2 United Sovereign Front (USF) 7
Alliance Overview 7
USF Alliance Members 8
1.2.3 Charter of Creed and Crown (CCC) 8
Alliance Overview 8
CCC Alliance Members 8
3.0 Basic Course of Play 8
3.1 Game Setup 8
3.2 Turn Structure 9
3.2.1 Mobilisation Phase 9
3.2.2 Action Phase 9
3.3 Victory Conditions 9
1.9.1 Game End 9
1.9.2 Victory Points 9
1.9.3 Starting Territory 10
1.9.5 Winning the Game 10
5.X Movement 10
5.X.1 Overview 10
5.X.2 Movement Rules 10
5.X.3 Terrain and Movement Costs 10
5.X.4 River Crossing 11
5.X.5 Enemy Interaction 11
5.X.6 Friendly Units and Sector Capacity 11
5.X.7 Movement Restrictions 12
5.X.10 Special Movement Rules 12
5.0 Combat 12
5.1 Combat Attributes 12
5.1.1 Strength 12
5.1.2 Defence 12
5.1.3 Movement 13
5.1.4 Size 13

X.X Combat Phase....13
X.X.X Overview....13
3.X.2 Initiating Combat....13
3.X.3 Combat Values....13
3.X.4 Modifiers and Final Values....13
3.X.5 Combat Resolution....14
Attacker rolls [0 to FA], Defender rolls [0 to FD]....14
3.X.6 Determining the Outcome....14
3.X.7 Step Losses and Unit Destruction....14
3.X.8 Multiple Attacks Against a Sector....14
3.X.9 Breakthrough Movement....14
3.X.10 Special Combat Rules....14
5.2 Land Combat....15
5.3 Supply....15
5.3 Logistics Units....15
5.3 City Supplies....15
5.3 Supply Shortage....15
5.3 Headquarters (HQ)....15
5.3.1 HQ Command Range and Size....16
5.3.2 Out of Command....16
1.3 Rotary Warfare....16
1.3.1 Range....16
1.3.2 Combat....16
1.6 Artillery Combat....16
1.6.1 Movement and Range....17
1.6.2 Artillery Combat....17
1.6.3 Counter-Battery Fire....17
5.2 Air Combat Mechanics....17
4.3 Airports and Operational Range....17
4.3.1 Tankers as Anchor Points....18
4.3.2 Operational Restrictions for Tankers and Helicopters....18
4.3.3 Impact of Tanker or Airport Destruction....18
4.2 Contested Airspace....18
2.3 Air Unit Damage and Reduction....18
2.3.1 Unit Destruction....18
2.3 Anti-Air....18
1.4.2Air Defence Zone....18
2.4.6 Anti-Air Combat....19
1.7 Suppression of Enemy Air Defences (SEAD)....19
1.8 AWACS (Airborne Warning and Control System)....19
1.8.1 AWACS Coverage....19
1.8.2 Protection of AWACS....19
1.9 Stealth Assets....20

1.9.1 Combat Effectiveness.... 20
1.9.2 Anti-Air Evasion.... 20
1.9 Strategic Airlifting & Airdropping.... 20
1.9.1 Operational Limits.... 20
1.9.2 Standard Airlift.... 20
1.9.3 Airdropping Operations.... 20
1.9.4 Airdrop Mishaps.... 20
1.9.5 Anti-Air Interaction.... 20
3.2 Naval Combat Mechanics.... 21
3.3 Supply.... 21
3.3.1 Supply Ships.... 21
3.3.2 Supply Shortage.... 21
3.6 Submarines.... 21
3.6.1 Independent Operations.... 21
3.6.2 Combat Mechanics.... 21
3.7 Anti-Submarine Warfare (ASW).... 22
3.7.1 Defensive Evasion.... 22
3.7.2 Strategic Implications.... 22
4.1 Sealift Operations.... 22
4.1.1 Transport Capacity.... 22
4.1.2 Loading and Unloading.... 22
4.1.3 Risk and Loss.... 22
5.6 Amphibious Operations.... 23
5.6.1 Requirements.... 23
5.6.2 Operation Resolution.... 23
5.6.3 Strategic Implications.... 23
5.7 Carrier Operations.... 23
10.1 Commonly Forgotten Rules.... 23
11.1 Glossary.... 23

Playtest Requirements

- Map
  - Roads
  - Numbers
    - Land
    - Sea
  - Cities
    - Names
  - Strategic Objectives
- Markers
  - Units
    - Front
    - Back

    -
- Rule Book
- Python Script
- Physical Items
    - Map
    - Units
    - Rule Book
- 3 players minimum
- Physically get together for the event

Example 1 — Phase-Group Turn Structure

(All players do Phase A → then all players do Phase B sequentially → then all players do Phase C)

Flow:

- All players receive and place new units.
- Each player takes their action/combat turn.
- All players check supply.
- All players check HQ

Need

- Map from project x
- Turn-based, each turn equals 1 day
- Turn 1 is the start of the war
- Each turn, gain more units based on the reinforcement rate/which is predetermined based on worldbuilding.
- Natural resources are essential strategic objectives
- Gain enough objectives to win the game.
- E.g: day 2 (turn 2) gain 1 Sovestia motorised infantry battalion (place in 123.3)
- All units and stats from Project X
- Worldbuilding from project x
- Include a glossary to the guide book

Want

- 3 players minimum
- NO BUILDING
- Not all nations have all units.
- Battle determined by dice or Python code, like in project x?????
- Include a way to track the game turn on the side of the board
- Include a front and back to each unit tile
-

Undecided

- Player controls a military alliance, either SSTO, USF or placeholder
- Mobilisation prioritisation determines what is ready first.
- Don't push too hard or start a nuclear war.
- Teck tree as part of the future game mode/optional DLC
-

Terrain Idea's

- 1. Each Sector has a terrain associated with it for example Plains. then a secter can also have another infranstructre thing associated with that sector for example a Forest sector can have a port . or a Savahnna sector can have a city. (ASK MORE QUESTIONS IF UNSURE)
- 2. each land sector is owned by a nation which is part of a faction.
- 3. Polar, Tundra, Deep water, Shallow Water, Mountain, Jungle, Plains, Forest, Savanna, Desert.
- 4. Rivers act as borders between sectors.
- 5.

Terrain:
Polar:

- Airstrikes

1.0 Introduction

Frontlines is a strategic modern warfare board game that challenges players to command nations, deploy forces, and outmaneuver opponents across land, sea, and air. Set in an alternate 21st-century world of shifting alliances and regional conflicts, the game combines tactical combat with long-term strategic planning.

Players take command of all military forces belonging to one of the three major alliances on the map, each with its own cities, capitals, and unique strategic opportunities. Using a diverse array of military units, players must expand their influence, seize enemy territories, and secure key cities.

1.1 Background

Syntaris and Helosia were once a single nation, but a civil war erupted when Syntaris attempted to seize power. The conflict split the country, with Helosia, the original government, retreating south of the Aegis Mountain Range.

After the retreat, the war reached a stalemate. The Veridian Union began backing Syntaris, while the Meridian Union supported Helosia, solidifying the divisions between the two factions.

The game begins when Syntaris launches a surprise attack on Helosia, seeking to end the original conflict once and for all. This action goes against the Veridian Union's current desire for peace, forcing the United Sovereign Front (USF), which includes both nations, to rapidly prepare its forces for war.

SSTO (Southern Security and Trade Organisation) is caught off guard and drawn into the conflict to defend Helosia, despite expecting no immediate hostilities. Meanwhile, the CCC (Charter of Creed and Crown) sees the growing war as an opportunity to advance its own interests while the other two blocs are preoccupied.

1.1.2 Alterra

Frontlines takes place on Alterra, an Earth-like world shaped by dramatic geological forces. In its earliest era, a colossal supervolcano erupted, pushing enough land upward to create the supercontinent of Primordia, the planet's only landmass above water at the time. For millions of years, this vast supercontinent dominated Alterra's surface. Around 60 million years ago, Primordia began to fracture and drift apart, eventually forming the five continents known today: Rivaran, Norland, Aurelia, Gaian, and Thalassia. Each continent developed its own distinct geography and cultures, setting the stage for the diverse and evolving world in which Frontlines unfolds.

1.2 Playable Alliances

Frontlines is fought between three major geopolitical blocs. Each bloc is playable by one or more players, who assume overall strategic command of all military forces belonging to that alliance. While each bloc has distinct political goals and internal dynamics, all are drawn into a rapidly escalating global conflict.

1.2.1 Southern Stability and Trade Organisation (SSTO)

The player controlling the SSTO assumes the role of Strategic Allied Commander of Joint Armed Forces (SACJAF), exercising unified command over all SSTO military assets across land, sea, and air.

Alliance Overview

The Southern Stability and Trade Organisation (SSTO) was formed to promote regional stability, economic cooperation, and collective security among southern nations. It was initially founded by the Meridian Union and the United Aequor Federation.

Five years ago, the Meridian Union proposed the expansion of the alliance by inviting the Aurorian Republic. Due to strained relations between Aequor and Aurorian, Aequor agreed only if the Democratic Assembly of Heliosia was included as well. This compromise marked the first major expansion of SSTO since its founding.

SSTO focuses on economic integration, diplomatic cooperation, and coordinated regional defence. While it does not actively pursue expansion, its rising influence has elevated it to a major power bloc, serving as a direct counterweight to the USF's growing reach.

SSTO Alliance Members

- Meridian Union
- United Aequor Federation
- Aurorian Republic
- Democratic Assembly of Heliosia

1.2.2 United Sovereign Front (USF)

The player controlling the USF assumes the role of Strategic Theatre Commander of Sovereign Forces (STC-SOF), directing the combined military power of all USF member states.

Alliance Overview

The United Sovereign Front (USF) was established by the Veridian Union alongside the Federal Socialist Republic of Azerland and the People's Republic of Sovestia in response to the expanding influence of SSTO, particularly following the inclusion of Helosia and Aurorian. Viewing this shift as a threat to the regional balance of power, the Veridian Union sought to consolidate authoritarian-aligned states into a unified front.

During the Helosia Civil War, SSTO support for the Helosian government created an opportunity for the USF to expand its influence. The Veridian Union successfully persuaded Sovestia to back the opposing faction, deepening tensions between the blocs. Azerland, however, chose not to participate in the conflict, creating internal strain within the USF and worsening relations with Syntaris.

The USF emphasises strong centralised authority, territorial expansion, military readiness, and economic self-sufficiency. Despite internal disagreements, the alliance prioritises unity in order to counter SSTO influence and assert its dominance on the global stage.

USF Alliance Members

- The Dictatorial Regime of the Veridian Union
- The Syntaris Union
- The People's Republic of Sovestia
- The Federal Socialist Republic of Azerland

1.2.3 Charter of Creed and Crown (CCC)

The player controlling the CCC assumes the role of Charter Watch Commander of the Unified Front (CWCUF), overseeing the collective defence and strategic interests of Charter members.

Alliance Overview

The Charter of Creed and Crown (CCC) is the oldest continuously existing international organisation in Alterra, predating modern alliance systems by centuries. It was initially formed by the United Kingdom of Astoria and the Bellavistian Theocratic Republic to formally recognise each other’s sovereignty and sacred authority, while preventing external interference in internal governance.

For most of its history, the CCC remained small, exclusive, and restrained, focused on legitimacy, continuity, and internal stability rather than territorial expansion. This stance shifted only recently with the admission of the Commonwealth of Taimat, prompted by growing USF influence in the Rivaran continent. This marked the first significant expansion of the Charter in centuries and signalled a more active role in global affairs.

The CCC seeks to preserve traditional authority, regime stability, and institutional continuity. While often acting as a balancing force rather than an aggressor, the Charter is willing to intervene selectively to protect its interests and ensure its long-term survival in an increasingly volatile world.

CCC Alliance Members

- The United Kingdom of Astoria
- The Bellavistian Theocratic Republic
- The Commonwealth of Tiamat

3.0 Basic Course of Play

3.1 Game Setup

To begin the game, position the map board in a central location accessible to all players. Ensure there is enough space around the board for players to manage their units, cards, and other components.

Next, organise all active units by faction. Each of the three factions must place their units onto the map in their designated starting sectors, as indicated on the board or in their faction setup guide. Ensure all units are correctly positioned before proceeding.

Once all factions have deployed their forces, the game is ready to begin.

3.2 Turn Structure

Each turn is divided into two phases:

3.2.1 Mobilisation Phase

All players deploy any new or reserve units onto the map at the same time. Units must be placed in valid sectors as defined by faction setup rules or controlled territories.

3.2.2 Action Phase

Following mobilisation, players take their Action Phases in a fixed order. The USF acts first, followed by SSTO, and then CCC. Each player completes their entire Action Phase before the next player begins.

During a player's Action Phase, units are activated individually in any sequence. A unit may move by spending its movement points and may attack once at any point during that movement. After combat, the unit may continue moving using any remaining movement points, provided it does not exceed its total movement allowance. Once a unit has completed its actions, it may not be used that turn again.

3.3 Victory Conditions

Victory in the game is determined by Victory Points (VP) earned through territorial gains and completed objectives. All players begin the game on Turn 1 with 0 VP. Victory Points are only calculated at the end of Turn 10.

1.9.1 Game End

The game ends at the end of Turn 10. No Victory Points are gained, lost, or tracked during the game prior to final scoring.

1.9.2 Victory Points

At the end of Turn 10, players score Victory Points based on enemy-controlled locations they currently occupy.

Victory Points are awarded as follows:

- Port or Airport: 1 VP
- City: 3 VP
- Capital City: 5 VP

1.9.3 Starting Territory

Locations initially controlled by a player at the start of the game provide 0 VP, regardless of whether they are still held at the end of the game. Recapturing a location that was originally yours does not grant VP. Any locations captured from an opponent and later lost do not contribute VP during final scoring. Victory Points are awarded only for net gains against enemy territory.

1.9.5 Winning the Game

At the conclusion of Turn 10, the player with the highest total Victory Points (VP) is the winner. If two or more players are tied, the tie is broken in the following order:

1. The player controlling the greatest number of enemy capital cities
2. The player controlling the greatest number of enemy cities

5.X Movement

5.X.1 Overview

Movement represents a unit's ability to reposition across the map during the Action Phase. Units expend Movement Points to enter adjacent sectors, allowing them to maneuver, reinforce positions, and prepare for combat.

In most cases, one Movement Point allows a unit to move into one adjacent sector. However, terrain and other conditions may increase or restrict movement.

5.X.2 Movement Rules

A unit may move a number of sectors up to its Movement value during its turn. Movement is conducted one sector at a time, with Movement Points being spent as each sector is entered.

A unit may only move into sectors that share a border with its current location. Movement may occur in any direction, provided the sectors are adjacent.

Movement must be completed before combat. A unit that has moved may then attack, but movement cannot be resumed after combat.

5.X.3 Terrain and Movement Costs

Terrain affects both where units can move and how much movement it costs to do so.

Some terrain types increase the Movement Point cost required to enter a sector. For example, crossing a river requires one additional Movement Point. Certain terrain may also impose penalties on movement, such as reducing a unit's effective movement capability while traversing it.

Some units may be restricted from entering specific terrain types entirely. For example, Armoured units may not enter mountain sectors, while Infantry units may do so, albeit with reduced mobility.

If a unit is capable of entering a terrain type, it must still pay any additional Movement Point costs or penalties associated with that terrain.

5.X.4 River Crossing

Units may cross rivers when moving between sectors, but doing so increases the cost of movement. Crossing a river requires one additional Movement Point.

If an Engineer unit is present in the same sector as the moving unit, this penalty may be ignored, representing the construction of a temporary bridge.

5.X.5 Enemy Interaction

Units may not enter sectors occupied by enemy units. Instead, a unit must stop in a sector adjacent to the enemy and may then initiate combat.

Units are free to move adjacent to enemy units without restriction. There are no Zones of Control; enemy units do not restrict movement beyond blocking entry into their sector.

5.X.6 Friendly Units and Sector Capacity

Units may move through sectors occupied by friendly units, but may not end their movement in a sector that has reached its capacity limit.

Each sector may contain a maximum of two units per domain (land, air, and naval) at any time. A unit may not enter a sector if doing so would exceed this limit.

This restriction reflects the logistical and tactical challenges of coordinating multiple forces within a confined area and ensures sectors remain manageable for both movement and combat.

Note: Some units may be exempt from this limit; refer to individual unit descriptions for details.

5.X.7 Movement Restrictions

A unit may not pass through or enter a sector occupied by enemy units. Movement must always proceed through valid, unoccupied sectors.

Once a unit begins movement, it must complete all movement before initiating combat. Movement cannot be split or resumed after an attack.

5.X.10 Special Movement Rules

Some unit types may follow modified movement rules based on their capabilities. These exceptions are described in their respective unit sections and override the standard movement rules where applicable.

5.0 Combat

Units in Project X are the building blocks of your military campaign. You begin each campaign with a pre-determined number of units, placed strategically across your nation. These units can vary widely, from small National Guard Companies to larger formations like armoured Corps or Artillery Batteries. By managing and deploying these units strategically, players can influence battle outcomes, control territories, and achieve overall victory in the game.

5.1 Combat Attributes

In your game, the attributes Strength, Defence, Logistics, and Movement define each unit's capabilities and effectiveness on the battlefield, influencing both combat outcomes and strategic planning.

5.1.1 Strength

Strength represents the offensive capability of a unit, indicating how much damage it can inflict on enemy units. A higher strength value means the unit can deal more damage in combat, making it more effective in attacking and destroying enemy forces.

5.1.2 Defence

Defence measures a unit's ability to withstand attacks and reduce the damage it takes from enemy strikes. Units with high defence values are more resilient and can survive longer in combat, making them ideal for holding strategic positions and protecting key areas. Defensive units are essential for maintaining front lines and providing cover for other forces.

5.1.3 Movement

Movement reflects the unit's speed and ability to maneuver across the battlefield. Units with high movement values can cover more ground quickly, allowing them to respond rapidly to changing combat situations, engage or disengage from enemies, and reposition strategically. This attribute is critical for units that must exploit enemy weaknesses, execute flanking maneuvers, or reach objectives quickly.

5.1.4 Size

Logistics represents the number of personnel and the scale of equipment within a unit. This attribute determines the size of a logistics unit required to be within range for the unit to be considered in supply.

X.X Combat Phase

X.X.X Overview

Combat occurs when a unit attacks an adjacent enemy-occupied sector during the Action Phase. Each combat is resolved individually using an opposed roll system based on the attacking unit’s strength and the defending unit’s defence.

Every combat will result in one of three outcomes: the attacker loses a size, the defender loses a size, or both units lose a size. No other outcomes occur in standard combat resolution.

3.X.2 Initiating Combat

To conduct an attack, a unit must be adjacent to an enemy-occupied sector. A unit may only attack once per turn. If multiple friendly units are adjacent to the same enemy sector, each may attack that sector, but each attack is resolved separately as its own combat.

When multiple attacks are made against the same sector, they are resolved one at a time in any order chosen by the attacking player. The results of each combat are applied immediately and will affect subsequent attacks against that sector.

3.X.3 Combat Values

Each unit has two core combat values: an Attack Strength and a Defence Value. These are the unit's base values and are used depending on whether the unit is attacking or defending.

Before combat is resolved, these base values are modified by terrain and situational effects to produce final combat values.

3.X.4 Modifiers and Final Values

Both the attacker and defender must apply all relevant modifiers before rolling. These modifiers may include terrain effects, such as river crossings or defensive terrain, as well as penalties from lack of supply or absence of headquarters support. Certain units may also apply additional modifiers based on their abilities or positioning.

After all modifiers are applied, each side will have a Final Attack Strength or Final Defence Value. If modifiers would reduce a value below zero, it is instead treated as zero. There is no upper limit to these values.

3.X.5 Combat Resolution

Combat is resolved by both players rolling a value based on their final combat strength.

Attacker rolls [0 to FA], Defender rolls [0 to FD]

The attacker rolls a number between 0 and their Final Attack Strength, inclusive. The defender rolls a number between 0 and their Final Defence Value, inclusive. Both rolls are made simultaneously or in quick succession.

3.X.6 Determining the Outcome

Once both values have been rolled, they are compared directly. If the attacker's roll is higher than the defender's roll, the defending unit loses one size. If the defender's roll is higher than the attacker's roll, the attacking unit loses one size. If both rolls are equal, both units lose one size.

3.X.7 Step Losses and Unit Destruction

When a unit loses a size, it is reduced by one level, such as from a battalion to a company. If a unit that must lose a size is already at its smallest possible size, it is immediately removed from the board and considered destroyed.
All losses are applied immediately before any further combat involving that sector is resolved.

3.X.8 Multiple Attacks Against a Sector

When multiple units attack the same sector, each combat is resolved individually. The defending unit's reduced size or destruction carries over between attacks. This means that earlier attacks may weaken or eliminate defenders, making subsequent attacks more effective.

3.X.9 Breakthrough Movement

If an Armoured or Mechanised unit attacks a sector and, as a result of that combat, all defending units in the sector are destroyed, that unit may immediately move into the now-empty sector. This is known as a Breakthrough.

A Breakthrough may only occur as a direct result of that unit's own attack and only into the sector it just cleared. No further combat is conducted as part of this movement and does not cost Movement Points.

3.X.10 Special Combat Rules

Some unit types, including Artillery and Anti-Air units, do not follow the standard combat procedure described above. These units use specialised rules that are described in their respective sections and are resolved separately from standard combat.

5.2 Land Combat

In Project X, land warfare is a critical aspect of gameplay, encompassing a variety of strategies, tactics, and engagements between opposing ground forces. Players command infantry, armoured units, artillery, and support elements to achieve strategic and tactical objectives on diverse terrains. Success in land warfare requires effective troop manoeuvring to gain advantageous positions, utilising terrain for defence and cover, and coordinating assaults to disrupt and defeat enemy forces. Balancing offensive and defensive operations is essential, with a focus on mobility, firepower, and logistical support to maintain campaign momentum. The ultimate goal in Project X's land warfare is to dominate the battlefield, control key territories, and achieve military objectives that align with the overall goals of the conflict.

5.3 Supply

Combat-capable units of a country's armed forces require supplies to operate effectively. Modern mechanised armies consume large amounts of food, fuel, ammunition, and repair equipment. Units can be supplied in two ways: via logistics units or Cities.

5.3 Logistics Units

A logistics unit can supply any combat unit that is the same size or smaller within a 2-sector radius.

Example: A Logistics Battalion can supply any unit of size 3 or smaller that is within 2 sectors.

5.3 City Supplies

A city can supply any unit stationed in its sector if there is a road connecting the city to the capital, provided the road is controlled by friendly forces. City supply can support units of any size.

5.3 Supply Shortage

If a unit does not receive supply, it suffers a Supply Shortage, which imposes the following effects:

- Cannot attack
- Cannot defend
- Can move only 1 sector per turn

5.3 Headquarters (HQ)

HQ units serve as the nerve centre of military operations, providing leadership, coordination, and command to ensure the effectiveness and readiness of military forces.

5.3.1 HQ Command Range and Size

A HQ unit commands all friendly combat units within a 2-sector radius whose unit size is equal to or smaller than the HQ unit's size. There is no limit to the number of units that may be commanded, provided they meet the size requirement.

Example: *A size 3 HQ unit commands all size 1, 2, and 3 units within 2 sectors. Size 4 units require a size 4 HQ unit within range to be considered in command.*

5.3.2 Out of Command

If a combat unit is not within command range of a suitable HQ unit, it becomes Disorganised and suffers the following effects:

- Can only move one sector per turn
- Deals half damage (round fractions down)
- Has half defence (round fractions down)

1.3 Rotary Warfare

Modern attack helicopters perform two primary battlefield roles: providing direct and accurate close air support to ground forces, and conducting anti-armour operations against concentrated enemy units.

1.3.1 Range

An Attack Helicopter may attack any ground unit within three sectors of a friendly Airfield or Airport. Due to the helicopter's ability to operate at low altitude using nap-of-the-earth (NOE) flight, it cannot be directly targeted by ground-based AA-capable units.

1.3.2 Combat

When attacking ground units, Attack Helicopters follow the same combat resolution rules as land units. An attack is successful if the helicopter's damage roll exceeds the defender's defence.

Each time an Attack Helicopter conducts an attack, there is a 25% chance that the helicopter is destroyed. This represents losses caused by ground-based air defence systems, regardless of the outcome of the attack.

Attack Helicopters may still be targeted and attacked by enemy aircraft, following the normal air-to-air combat rules.

1.6 Artillery Combat

Artillery is a key component of modern warfare, delivering powerful and sustained fire over long distances. It enhances combined arms operations and provides crucial support to frontline units.

1.6.1 Movement and Range

To attack, regular artillery must spend 1 movement point. Mechanised artillery may attack without spending movement points. Artillery units can attack any enemy ground units within 2 sectors.

1.6.2 Artillery Combat

When an artillery attack is successful, the defending unit is either suppressed, destroyed or no effect, determined by a 50/25/25 roll:

- Destroyed: The unit is removed from play.
- Suppressed: The unit cannot move during its next turn.
- No Effect: The Attacking Unit missed, nothing happens to the defender.

If the artillery attack is unsuccessful, the defender remains unaffected. The attacker is never affected by its own artillery attack.

1.6.3 Counter-Battery Fire

Whenever a friendly artillery unit fires, any enemy artillery units within range (2 sectors) of the firing artillery may automatically perform a counter-battery attack against it, regardless of the outcome of the original attack.

- Counter-battery attacks do not require movement points.
- Counter-Battery Fire uses normal artillery combat rules (destroyed or suppressed or miss).
- Multiple enemy artillery units may fire CB simultaneously if they are in range.
-

Example: *Your size 3 artillery fires at an enemy infantry unit. An enemy size 2 artillery is within 2 sectors of your firing artillery. That enemy artillery automatically rolls a counter-battery attack against your size 3 unit.*

5.2 Air Combat Mechanics

In Project X, the aerial combat mechanics are designed to simulate realistic and strategic air operations. Players must consider factors like aircraft type, range, refuelling, and anti-air defences, with every decision impacting the success of air missions and overall air superiority. Strategic planning and timing are key to achieving dominance in the skies.

4.3 Airports and Operational Range

Airports serve as the primary bases and anchor points for all aircraft operations. Each aircraft may only operate within its movement range measured in sectors from a friendly airport or tanker acting as an anchor point.

Example Operational Limits:

- *Multi-Role Fighters (MRFs): 4 sectors from an anchor point*
- *Bombers: 10 sectors from an anchor point*
- *Helicopters: follow their own defined range limits*

Aircraft cannot operate beyond their maximum range from a friendly anchor point. Strategically positioned airports and tankers is critical, as they define the area in which air units can project power.

4.3.1 Tankers as Anchor Points

Aerial refuelling aircraft *(Tankers)* function as mobile anchor points, extending the operational area for friendly aircraft. Aircraft may operate up to their movement range measured from a tanker, just as they would from an airport. Tankers allow aircraft to remain within operational limits while conducting missions far from fixed bases.

4.3.2 Operational Restrictions for Tankers and Helicopters

Tankers and helicopters cannot operate from another tanker. They must use an airport as their base of operations. This ensures that operational ranges remain realistic and prevents chains of mobile anchor points.

4.3.3 Impact of Tanker or Airport Destruction

If a friendly airport or aerial refuelling tanker is destroyed, any aircraft relying on that anchor point for operations and not within range of another airport or tanker will be lost. These aircraft cannot complete their mission without a functioning anchor point and are considered destroyed. Strategic protection of airports and tankers is therefore critical to maintaining operational air capabilities.

4.2 Contested Airspace

When entering a sector containing enemy air units, air units may either bypass the sector or engage the enemy. Bypassing costs 2 movement points to represent the extra effort required to avoid detection or interception. Engaging the enemy costs 1 movement point and represents direct combat with units in the sector.

2.3 Air Unit Damage and Reduction

When an air unit is hit during combat, its size is immediately reduced to the next smaller size category. This reduction represents aircraft losses and a decrease in the unit's overall combat effectiveness.

2.3.1 Unit Destruction

If an air unit is already at its smallest size category and is hit again, it is permanently destroyed and removed from play. This applies regardless of the source of damage.

2.3 Anti-Air

Anti-Air units are responsible for defending airspace and denying enemy air operations. They establish an Air Defence Zone around their position and automatically engage hostile aircraft that enter this zone.

1.4.2Air Defence Zone

An Anti-Air unit controls a one-sector radius around itself, known as its Air Defence Zone. Any enemy air unit that enters or operates within this zone is automatically engaged by the Anti-Air unit.

2.4.6 Anti-Air Combat

When an Anti-Air unit engages an enemy air unit within its Air Defence Zone, the aircraft must resolve an evasion check based on its classification.

- Non-stealth air units have an 80% chance of being hit by Anti-Air fire.
- Stealth air units have a 20% chance of being hit, reflecting their reduced detectability and advanced countermeasures.

If the Anti-Air attack is successful, the targeted air unit loses one size, representing aircraft losses and reduced combat effectiveness. If the attack is unsuccessful, no damage is dealt.

1.7 Suppression of Enemy Air Defences (SEAD)

SEAD (Suppression of Enemy Air Defences) is a specialised air operation used to neutralise enemy Anti-Air units and reduce the effectiveness of air defence zones. The chance of destroying the Anti-Air unit is a flat 60% and is not affected by the strength or defence of either the Anti-Air unit or the attacking aircraft.

When an aircraft conducts a SEAD mission against an Anti-Air unit:

1. The Anti-Air unit fires first, attempting to destroy the attacking aircraft.
2. If the attacking aircraft survives, it has a 60% chance to destroy the targeted Anti-Air unit.

Stealth aircraft conducting SEAD missions are especially effective. Due to their reduced detectability, they have only a 20% chance of being hit by Anti-Air fire, significantly increasing their likelihood of surviving the engagement and successfully eliminating the target.

1.8 AWACS (Airborne Warning and Control System)

AWACS units provide airborne command and control, enhancing the effectiveness of friendly air operations across a wide area.

1.8.1 AWACS Coverage

An AWACS unit supports all friendly air units within a two-sector radius. Friendly Air units within this coverage area receive a 50% increase to both strength and defence, reflecting improved situational awareness, coordination, and targeting.

The effects of AWACS do not stack. If multiple AWACS units cover the same air unit, only one bonus is applied.

1.8.2 Protection of AWACS

AWACS units are high-value assets and are especially vulnerable if left unprotected. Players are strongly encouraged to escort and defend AWACS units, as their loss can significantly reduce the effectiveness of friendly air operations and control of contested airspace.

1.9 Stealth Assets

Stealth aircraft are designed to be difficult to detect and target, providing a significant advantage in modern air warfare. Stealth assets are rare, high-impact units that can decisively influence air operations, but they come at a high strategic cost.

1.9.1 Combat Effectiveness

Stealth aircraft are twice as effective as non-stealth aircraft in terms of both strength and defence, representing superior sensors, materials, and combat systems.

1.9.2 Anti-Air Evasion

When engaged by Anti-Air units, stealth aircraft have a 20% chance of being hit, compared to the 80% chance for non-stealth aircraft. This reduced hit probability greatly increases their survivability against air defences.

1.9 Strategic Airlifting & Airdropping

Strategic Airlift Aircraft (SAA) provide rapid deployment of ground units across long distances. A single SAA unit can transport any ground unit or Attack helicopters up to its own size, except for Armoured units, which cannot be transported due to weight and logistical constraints.

For example, a Size 3 SAA can transport Size 3, 2, or 1 ground units, excluding armoured units.

1.9.1 Operational Limits

SAA units operate within their movement range (10 sectors) from an airport or a tanker unit. SAAs can operate from another tanker as their operational anchor.

1.9.2 Standard Airlift

Moving ground units using a Strategic Airlift Aircraft (SAA) between friendly airbases is a safe and reliable operation. Units are transported at no risk of suppression, size reduction, or destruction. This represents conventional redeployment under secure conditions.

1.9.3 Airdropping Operations

SAA units can perform airdrop missions to deploy ground units directly into friendly, contested, or enemy-controlled sectors.

1.9.4 Airdrop Mishaps

There is a 20% chance that the dropped unit is reduced to the next smaller size due to operational errors, rough landing, or logistical mishaps. The SAA unit itself is not destroyed by the airdrop, even if the dropped unit is damaged or eliminated.

1.9.5 Anti-Air Interaction

If the target sector is within an enemy AA Air Defence Zone, Standard Anti-Air rules apply if the SAA is engaged.

3.2 Naval Combat Mechanics

In Project X, naval warfare is a pivotal element, allowing players to control the seas and project power across vast distances. Naval units offer diverse capabilities for both offensive and defensive operations. Naval units can play a vital role in deploying ground forces to strategic locations, essential for amphibious assaults and securing key coastal areas. The game mechanics emphasise the importance of naval dominance, with sea control influencing supply routes, reinforcements, and overall strategic flexibility. By effectively managing your nation's naval assets, you can establish maritime superiority, support land campaigns, and execute complex joint operations, making naval warfare a decisive factor in achieving victory.

3.3 Supply

All combat-capable naval units require supply. Modern fleets consume large amounts of food, repair materials, fuel, and ammunition to remain operational. Unlike land forces, naval units can only receive supplies from supply ships.

3.3.1 Supply Ships

A Supply Ship can provide supplies to any naval units that are the same size or smaller within a 2-sector radius. For example, a fleet consisting of a size 3 ship can only be supplied by a Size 3 or greater supply ship in range.

3.3.2 Supply Shortage

Naval units that are not supplied enter a supply shortage. Units in supply shortage suffer the following penalties:

- Cannot defend
- Cannot attack
- Can only move one sector per turn

3.6 Submarines

Submarines are a key element of modern naval warfare, capable of influencing engagements through stealth, deterrence, and precision attacks. Whether operating independently or in support of surface forces, submarines shape naval combat by threatening enemy units before traditional surface engagements occur.

3.6.1 Independent Operations

Submarines can operate independently and conduct strikes against enemy naval units. A submarine may perform only one action per turn and cannot attack and defend in the same turn. Submarines do not require supply ships to operate and are not affected by naval supply rules.

3.6.2 Combat Mechanics

When a submarine attacks an enemy naval unit:

- There is a 25% chance the attack fails, and the target takes no damage.
- If the attack succeeds, the target is instantly destroyed.

Submarines are therefore high-risk, high-reward units that can decisively impact naval engagements when used strategically.

3.7 Anti-Submarine Warfare (ASW)

Submarines can only be engaged and destroyed by:

- Destroyers
- Other submarines
- Marine Patrol Aircraft (MPA)

3.7.1 Defensive Evasion

Whenever a submarine is attacked, there is a 50% chance it takes no damage, regardless of the attacking unit's strength or roll. This reflects the stealth and evasive capabilities of modern submarines.

3.7.2 Strategic Implications

Anti-submarine operations require careful planning. Players must use specialised units or aircraft to counter submarines effectively, while submarines themselves can threaten surface fleets and disrupt enemy operations if left unchecked.

4.1 Sealift Operations

Sealift operations enable the strategic movement of ground forces across bodies of water using naval transport ships. This capability allows nations to reinforce distant territories, reposition forces, and support overseas operations.

4.1.1 Transport Capacity

A transport ship may carry one ground unit that is the same size or smaller than the transport ship. Only one unit may be carried at a time.

4.1.2 Loading and Unloading

- Loading a ground unit onto a transport ship consumes the transport ship's action.
- Unloading a ground unit from a transport ship also consumes the transport ship's action.

4.1.3 Risk and Loss

If a transport ship is destroyed while carrying a ground unit, the transported unit is immediately destroyed as well.

If a transport ship is reduced in size while carrying a ground unit (for example, from XXX to XX), the carried ground unit is reduced by the same number of size levels. If the carried unit is already at its smallest size and would be reduced further, it is destroyed.

5.6 Amphibious Operations

Amphibious operations allow a nation to project military power from sea to land, enabling the rapid deployment of ground forces onto hostile or contested coastlines. This capability is strategically valuable for securing beachheads, opening new fronts, and bypassing enemy land defences.

5.6.1 Requirements

To conduct an amphibious operation, a nation must have an Amphibious Assault Ship (AAS) located in a shallow water sector adjacent to land. The AAS must have at least 1 remaining movement point to unload land units onto the shore.

5.6.2 Operation Resolution

If there are no enemy units in any sector adjacent to the AAS, the amphibious operation is automatically successful, and all landed units arrive without casualties. If enemy units are present in any adjacent sector to the AAS, the landing is contested. Each friendly land unit involved in the operation has a 50% chance of being destroyed when moving onto land.

5.6.3 Strategic Implications

Amphibious operations are high-risk, high-reward actions. Securing nearby sea zones and suppressing enemy forces before landing greatly increases the likelihood of a successful operation and preserves valuable ground units.

5.7 Carrier Operations

Whatever size x it is is how many air units it can hold and the same size, xxx carrier can hold size up to 3 xxx air units.
Act as AA units
Cannot attack other naval units, must rely on escorts or aircraft.

10.1 Commonly Forgotten Rules

11.1 Glossary

Term	Definition
Victory Point (VP)	A measure of progress toward winning the game, earned through achieving objectives, controlling key locations, or accomplishing specific actions.
USF	United Sovereign Front
SSTO	Southern Stability and Trade Organisation
CCC	Charter of Crown and Creed
Command and Control (C2)	The authority and capability to plan, direct, coordinate, and monitor forces and operations.
Unit	A combat game piece representing a military element under a player's control.
Strength	Represents the combat capability of a unit.
Defence	Represents a unit's ability to resist attacks.
Size	Represents the scale of a unit and determines its supply requirements.
Movement	Represents how far a unit can travel in a single turn.
Sector	A designated area of the game map that can be controlled, contested, or traversed by units.
City	A populated urban area on the game map that can be controlled or contested by players.
Headquarters (HQ)	A central command element responsible for planning, coordination, and command and control of forces.
Rotary	The use of rotary-wing aircraft

Warfare	to conduct combat, transport, reconnaissance, and support operations.
Nap-of-the-earth (NOE)	A low-altitude flight technique used by aircraft to avoid detection and reduce exposure to enemy fire by following the contours of the terrain.
Anti-Air (AA)	Weapons, systems, or measures designed to detect, target, and destroy hostile aircraft.
Counter-Battery	Operations or fire directed at enemy artillery to detect, target, and neutralise it before it can inflict damage.
Airport	A facility that provides takeoff, landing, and support services for aircraft, including maintenance, refuelling, and logistical operations.
Aerial Refuelling	The process of transferring fuel from one aircraft to another during flight, extending the range and endurance of the receiving aircraft.
Air Defence Zone	A designated area in which anti-air systems provide protective coverage against hostile aircraft.
Stealth	The capability of a system or platform to reduce detection and tracking by enemy sensors, particularly radar and air-defence systems.
Suppression of Enemy Air Defences (SEAD)	Operations aimed at neutralising, destroying, or temporarily disabling enemy air-defence systems to allow friendly aircraft to operate safely in contested airspace.
AWACS (Airborne Warning and	An airborne system that provides wide-area surveillance, early warning, and command and control support for air

Control System)	operations.
Airlift	The transportation of troops, equipment, and supplies by aircraft to support military operations, often used to rapidly reinforce or resupply units in distant or contested areas.
Airdrop	The delivery of troops, equipment, or supplies from aircraft by parachute or other means allowing forces to be inserted directly into areas without requiring a landing site.
Naval	Relating to warships, maritime operations, and the conduct of military actions at sea.
Anti-Sub Warfare (ASW)	Operations and systems designed to detect, track, and neutralise enemy submarines.
Sealift	The transportation of troops, equipment, and supplies by sea using transport ships to support military operations.
Amphibious Warfare	Operations involving the movement of forces from sea to land to conduct land-based military actions.